Aashish Chhabra

Platform Engineering & Architecture Leader

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Hands-on platform engineering and architecture leader with 12+ years of experience. My career has moved from application development, to running large data platforms, to building the automation and security that engineering teams depend on, to designing and owning platform products for Airtel B2B Cloud customers. I personally built the central CI/CD framework that connects 170+ repositories to automated, centrally secured pipelines, and I am service owner and technical lead of Kafka-as-a-Service, a managed multi-tenant Kafka platform. I provide line and functional leadership across Development and DevOps, and I still review code, designs and technical decisions myself.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Personally built a central, marker-file-driven CI/CD framework now connecting 170+ repositories to automated build, test and security-scan pipelines.
- Moved image security scanning from Prisma Cloud to Wiz across 170+ repositories in one central change, with no work required from developers.
- Engineered and ran a 9-broker bare-metal Kafka platform carrying about 40 Gbps of combined traffic (bytes in plus bytes out, including replication).
- Sole administrator of a production Cloudera platform as it grew from about 15 to about 390 servers.
- Planned and executed the replacement of the Cloudera NameNode server with no business downtime.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Platform & Data: Apache Kafka, Cloudera CDH/CDP, Hortonworks HDP, Apache Hive, Sqoop, Spark Operator, Trino, YARN, Zookeeper, Apache Airflow

CI/CD & Security: Jenkins, Central CI/CD framework (marker-file driven), Argo CD, Helm, Ansible, Black Duck, Coverity, Wiz, Temporal

Containers & Cloud: OpenShift (OCP), Kubernetes, Docker, Docker Swarm, Airtel B2B Cloud, Microsoft Azure (AZ-900 certified)

Observability: Elastic Stack (ELK), Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, Kafka UI

Languages & Data Stores: Python, Java, Shell, SQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, MySQL, SQL Server

Frameworks: Java Spring Boot, React, Smithy, Pandas

Systems: RHEL/CentOS, Kernel tuning, Systemd, Kerberos, Ranger, Active Directory and LDAP integration

AI-Assisted Engineering: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Lead Engineer, Data Techops (DGM), Xtelify Limited (the Airtel engineering organisation; formerly Bharti Airtel Limited)

December 2024 – Present | Gurugram, India

- Personally built and maintain, with my team, a central marker-file-driven CI/CD framework: a repository needs only a small marker file to be wired automatically into shared build, test and security-scan pipelines. It serves 170+ repositories across many projects and business lines.
- Moved image security scanning from Prisma Cloud to Wiz across 170+ repositories in one central change, with no repository-level work for developers; Black Duck and Coverity continue to run alongside it.

- Service owner and technical lead of Kafka-as-a-Service, a managed multi-tenant Kafka platform for Airtel B2B Cloud customers: architecture, technology choices (React, Smithy, Java Spring Boot, Temporal, PostgreSQL, Redis, Helm, Argo CD), pull-request reviews, security analysis and service readiness.
- Implemented OpenTelemetry for Kafka-as-a-Service observability, alongside Prometheus, Grafana and Elastic monitoring of the service and the clusters it creates.
- Contribute to the architecture and packaging of CDE (Converged Data Engine), Airtel's in-house Data Mesh platform, as a B2B Cloud service, covering the cloud environment, networks, sign-in integration and customer readiness.
- Provide line and functional leadership across Development and DevOps: hiring and interviewing, performance reviews, talent discussions and technical direction.
- Work with senior leaders on infrastructure planning, the annual operating plan, software licensing, architecture and security for B2B Cloud; contribute to the yearly capacity plan for on-premises compute and storage.
- Use Claude Code for pull-request review, security and bug analysis, and frontend/backend consistency checks; lead the introduction of AI-assisted engineering practices across the team.

Tools: Jenkins, Bitbucket, Black Duck, Coverity, Wiz, React, Smithy, Java Spring Boot, Temporal, PostgreSQL, Redis, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, Elastic, Helm, Argo CD, Claude Code

Lead Engineer, Bharti Airtel Limited, then Xtelify Limited (same organisation; legal-entity change in August 2024)

June 2021 – November 2024 | Gurugram, India

- Engineered and ran a Kafka platform on 9 bare-metal brokers carrying about 40 Gbps of combined traffic (bytes in plus bytes out, including replication), taking in streaming data from across India.
- Automated cluster creation with Python and Ansible, ran Kerberos and SCRAM sign-in on separate ports, added Cruise Control rebalancing, Grafana dashboards and phone alerts, and tuned the operating system (network buffers, interrupt handling, file-handle limits) to keep up with traffic.
- Set Airtel's Elastic Stack monitoring standards (central logging, centrally managed agents on VMs, bare metal and Kubernetes, application tracing) and drove adoption before handing it on.
- Led and contributed to moving applications from Docker Swarm and server installs to OpenShift; deployed Helm charts, troubleshot production container workloads and hardened them with security contexts.
- Set up Spark Operator, Trino (community Helm charts, company sign-in) and JupyterHub (LDAP sign-in) for developer teams.
- Worked with security and development teams to add vulnerability scanning to build pipelines, and designed an early single-workflow CI/CD approach (2023) that was later rebuilt into the central framework.
- Handed Cloudera administration to other engineers and administrators in order to take on this new work.

Tools: Apache Kafka, Cruise Control, Kafka UI, Grafana, Elastic Stack, OpenShift, Kubernetes, Docker Swarm, Helm, Spark Operator, Trino, JupyterHub, Jenkins, Python, Ansible

Senior Software Engineer, Bharti Airtel Limited

September 2019 – May 2021 | Gurugram, India

- Sole administrator of the production Cloudera platform as it grew from about 15 to about 390 servers: installation, configuration, upgrades, repairs and capacity growth.
- Planned and worked on the migration from CDH 5.8 to CDP 7.1.6 with developers and operations, and planned and executed the replacement of the NameNode server with no business downtime.
- Planned and deployed disaster recovery for the production platform.
- Automated daily housekeeping with Python, shell scripts, Ansible, Jenkins and Airflow schedules.

Tools: Cloudera CDH and CDP, HDFS, YARN, Python, Shell, Ansible, Jenkins, Apache Airflow

Senior Software Engineer, NCR Corporation

January 2018 – September 2019 | Gurugram, India

- Built and ran an Enterprise Data Lake on Hortonworks HDP end to end: cluster installs and upgrades, Kerberos with Active Directory, Ranger access policies, and on-call support.

- Kept data flowing with Sqoop ingestion from relational databases (ATM, self-checkout and point-of-sale data), Hive transformations and automated Hive partition repair.
- Automated user onboarding with shell scripts, divided cluster capacity between teams, and wrote Python and Pandas reports on cluster jobs.

Tools: Hortonworks HDP 2.6, Ambari, YARN, Hive, Ranger, Knox, Oozie, Kerberos, Active Directory, Sqoop, Python, Pandas, CentOS 7

Software Engineer (Associate Software Engineer until June 2015), Tech Mahindra

June 2014 – December 2017 | Pune, India

- Built Java and JSP application screens and SQL reporting logic for an AT&T quotations system (client work for Amdocs and AT&T).
- Member of the pilot that moved quotations data into Hadoop (Sqoop, Hive, Pig), then worked on the follow-on AT&T Quotations Warehouse System: took part in cluster planning and built ingestion, Hive transformations and Oozie workflows.
- Wrote database change scripts, copied data between Production, Stage and Development environments, and prepared deployment documents.

Tools: Core Java, JSP, Microsoft SQL Server, MySQL, Sqoop, Hive, Pig, Oozie

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Hortonworks HDP Certified Developer (2017); Microsoft Azure Fundamentals, AZ-900 (2024); IIM Indore, Management Development Programme (2024)

AWARDS

Airtel: Employee of the Month, Eureka Award, Best Team Award

Tech Mahindra: ACE Award, Bravo Award, Highest Learner Award, Pat on the Back Award, Best Team Award

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Electronics and Communication Engineering. Global Institute of Technology, Jaipur (Rajasthan Technical University, Kota), 2010 – 2014

REFEREES

Referees available on request.